MONTHLY BUDGET EXAMPLE: Nurse with 3 years experience, single, renting in a mid-sized city

All values in USD/month. Exchange rates: 1 EUR = 1.10 USD | 1 GBP = 1.30 USD | 1 CAD = 0.72 USD | 1 NZD = 0.58 USD

	Germany	USA	Canada	New Zealand	UK
INCOME					
Gross Monthly Salary	$4,000	$6,250	$4,330	$4,000	$3,830
DEDUCTIONS					
Income Tax	-$560	-$940	-$650	-$680	-$575
Social Security / Pension	-$410	-$478	-$260	$0	-$375
Health Insurance (employee share)	Included above	-$450	Included in tax	Included in tax	Included above
=Net Monthly Salary	**$3,030**	**$4,382**	**$3,420**	**$3,320**	**$2,880**
FIXED MONTHLY COSTS					
Rent (1-bedroom apartment)	-$715	-$1,400	-$1,100	-$810	-$1,040
Utilities (electricity, heating, water, internet)	-$220	-$200	-$180	-$170	-$210
Groceries & Food	-$300	-$450	-$350	-$380	-$350
Transportation	-$60 (Deutschlandticket)	-$550 (car required)	-$350	-$250	-$180
Phone (mobile)	-$25	-$70	-$55	-$45	-$40
Out-of-pocket health costs (co-pays, prescriptions)	-$20	-$250	-$80	-$60	-$30
=Total Fixed Costs	**-$1,340**	**-$2,920**	**-$2,115**	**-$1,715**	**-$1,850**
MONTHLY SAVINGS POTENTIAL					
Money left at end of month	**$1,690**	**$1,462**	**$1,305**	**$1,605**	**$1,030**

KEY INSIGHT: Despite a lower gross salary, Germany offers the highest disposable income due to: (1) Affordable rent in mid-sized cities, (2) Deutschlandticket for just $60/month nationwide public transport, (3) No extra health insurance costs - everything is included, (4) Low co-pays and prescription costs. In the USA, the high gross salary is consumed by expensive rent, mandatory car ownership, health insurance premiums, and high co-pays.

HIDDEN BENEFITS NOT REFLECTED IN SALARY (included in Germany, extra cost elsewhere)

Paid vacation days/year	**26-30 days**	10-15 days	10-20 days	20 days	27 days
Paid sick leave	**Up to 6 weeks full pay**	Depends on employer, often limited	Varies by province	5-10 days/year	NHS sick pay scheme
Parental leave	**14 months paid (shared)**	0 weeks federally paid	15-18 weeks	26 weeks (some paid)	39 weeks paid
Childcare (monthly cost if applicable)	**$0-350/month (subsidized)**	$1,200-2,500/month	$200-1,000/month	$600-1,200/month	$800-1,500/month
Pension / Retirement	Statutory pension included	Social Security only, 401k optional	CPP included	KiwiSaver (employee contributes)	NHS Pension included
Path to citizenship (for Indian nurses)	**~3-5 years**	17+ years (EB-3 backlog for Indians!)	4-6 years	~5 years	6-7 years

BMC Nurses